

Document with Footnotes

Footnote Tester

April 13, 2026

1 Introduction

Footnotes are commonly used in academic writing¹ to provide supplementary information without cluttering the main text.

2 Technical Details

The PDF format stores footnotes as regular text positioned at the bottom of the page². This means the converter must use spatial analysis to identify them.

Our approach detects footnotes by looking for small-font text blocks near the bottom margin³. These blocks are then tagged as footnotes in the intermediate representation.

3 Limitations

Multi-page footnotes⁴ present additional challenges.

4 Conclusion

Footnote handling is important for academic document conversion. The key signals are: small font size, bottom-of-page positioning, and superscript reference markers in the body text.

¹This is a simple footnote that provides additional context.

²PDF does not have a semantic concept of “footnotes” — they are simply text blocks positioned near the page bottom.

³Specifically, we check for text blocks where the font size is less than 80% of the body font size and the vertical position is in the bottom 15% of the page.

⁴Footnotes that are too long to fit on a single page will overflow to the next page. This is a known edge case that our current implementation does not handle perfectly.